

ACTIVITY 01

Picture Story, Then "Say It Again Better"

Core push. *Learners narrate, notice a gap, and reformulate the same message with greater precision.*

Purpose. Push narrative production while making learners retrieve language, notice what is missing, and improve a second version.	Best for. A2-B2; pairs or groups of 3-4
Materials. A 4-6 image sequence, prompt card, and optional target-language checklist	Timing. 15-20 minutes

WHY THIS IS PUSHED OUTPUT

The instructor does not supply the missing form immediately; the learner must search, test, and modify output to communicate the story more clearly.

PROCEDURE

- 1. Plan.** Show the picture sequence and give learners 60-90 seconds to decide the main events and useful vocabulary.
- 2. First narration.** Learner A tells the story for about two minutes while Learner B listens for the overall meaning. The listener may ask genuine comprehension questions.
- 3. Instructor listen-in.** Circulate and record only one or two teachable gaps, such as an unclear connector, missing past-tense form, or vague verb. Ask follow-up questions rather than correcting immediately.
- 4. Focused push.** Prompt the speaker to try again: add a reason, make the sequence clearer, include a precise verb, or use the target form.
- 5. Second narration.** Learners retell the story to a new partner. The second listener compares the message, not just the grammar, and asks for clarification when needed.
- 6. Debrief.** Ask: What did you change? Which word or structure did you have to search for? What made the second version easier?

INSTRUCTOR PROMPTS

- What happened after that?
- Can you say that more precisely?
- Try that sentence again using because, although, or while.
- What word were you looking for?

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

- The second version is longer or more specific.
- Learners self-correct, add connectors, or replace vague verbs.
- Pauses decrease because the message has already been planned.

VARIATIONS

- Use an information-gap picture set so partners see different images.
- Advanced learners defend a particular interpretation of an ambiguous image.

WATCH OUT

Do not interrupt every error. Preserve the meaning-focused flow and record only a small number of useful examples.

ACTIVITY 02

Information-Gap Troubleshooting

Core push. *Learners must ask, clarify, and reformulate because each partner holds information the other needs.*

Purpose. Create a genuine need for precise language, clarification requests, and repair during a problem-solving exchange.	Best for. A2-C1; pairs
Materials. Two non-overlapping schedules, maps, procedures, or problem cards; answer sheet	Timing. 15-25 minutes

WHY THIS IS PUSHED OUTPUT

The gap makes communicative success depend on the quality of learner output. When the partner cannot act on an utterance, the speaker has to clarify or rephrase.

PROCEDURE

- 1. Set the gap.** Give Learner A and Learner B different versions of a schedule, map, itinerary, technical problem, or set of procedural steps. Do not let them show the cards initially.
- 2. Set the outcome.** Tell pairs they must reach one concrete solution: fix the itinerary, identify the missing step, locate a place, or diagnose the problem.
- 3. First attempt.** Learners exchange information and ask questions. The instructor listens for vague references, incomplete explanations, and moments when a partner cannot proceed.
- 4. Instructor push.** Ask: Exactly when? Which detail matters? How do you know? Encourage the learner to explain the same point another way.
- 5. Repair round.** Require one deliberate repair: each learner must make one clarification request and one reformulation before the pair finalizes the solution.
- 6. Check and reflect.** Partners compare the final solution with the answer key or reveal their cards. Briefly discuss which wording prevented or solved confusion.

INSTRUCTOR PROMPTS

- Could you explain that another way?
- Do you mean before or after the meeting?
- Which detail is essential for the solution?
- Ask your partner to clarify that point.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

- Learners use clarification requests rather than guessing silently.
- Turns become longer and more explicit after a breakdown.
- Temporal, spatial, or procedural language becomes more accurate.

VARIATIONS

- Ban one high-frequency word and make learners paraphrase it.
- Assign unequal roles, such as customer/technician or traveler/agent.

WATCH OUT

Make sure the information gap is real and that the stronger speaker cannot simply complete the task alone. Require both partners to contribute essential information.

ACTIVITY 03

Describe and Draw

Core push. *A hidden image gives immediate evidence of whether the speaker's language is specific and comprehensible.*

Purpose. Push spatial, descriptive, and relational language by making imprecision visible in a partner's drawing.	Best for. A1-B2; pairs
Materials. A hidden picture, blank paper or a shared drawing tool, and two or three target features	Timing. 15-20 minutes

WHY THIS IS PUSHED OUTPUT

The listener cannot rely on shared visual access. The speaker must produce enough detail, then revise the description when the drawing reveals a gap in comprehensibility.

PROCEDURE

- 1. Assign roles.** Give the image only to the Speaker. The Listener has paper and pencil and must not see the original until the reveal.
- 2. First description.** The Speaker describes the image while the Listener draws. The Listener may ask questions, but the Speaker should do most of the language work.
- 3. Target the push.** Choose two or three features to emphasize, such as prepositions, comparatives, sequencing words, relative clauses, or shape vocabulary.
- 4. Repair ambiguity.** When the Listener hesitates or draws the wrong feature, pause and ask the Speaker to specify location, size, shape, or relationship.
- 5. Reveal and compare.** Place the drawing beside the original. Learners identify which descriptions led to accurate details and which required more precise wording.
- 6. Reverse roles.** Use a new image and switch roles. Ask learners to apply one improvement from the first round.

INSTRUCTOR PROMPTS

- Where exactly is it?
- What is it next to or underneath?
- Can you describe the shape or relative size?
- Your partner seems unsure. How could you clarify?

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

- Learners use more specific prepositions and relational phrases.
- Speakers notice ambiguity and repair without waiting for the answer.
- The second description produces a closer match to the original.

VARIATIONS

- Use spot-the-difference pictures or a classroom map.
- For advanced learners, describe a technical diagram or process.

WATCH OUT

Keep the focus on communicative precision, not on testing isolated vocabulary. Gestures may support meaning, but prompt learners to verbalize the key relationship.

ACTIVITY 04

Three-Round Personal Story

Core push. Purposeful repetition lets learners reuse content while the instructor raises the demand for fluency, complexity, or precision.

Purpose. Use repeated speaking turns to build fluency and automaticity while creating new opportunities to notice and fill productive gaps.	Best for. A2-C1; groups of 3-4
Materials. Prompt cards, timer, and optional target-language checklist or recording device	Timing. 20-30 minutes

WHY THIS IS PUSHED OUTPUT

Content planning becomes easier after the first telling, freeing attention for form, vocabulary, organization, and interactional detail in later rounds.

PROCEDURE

- 1. Choose and plan.** Give a prompt such as a memorable trip, a difficult decision, or a time something went wrong. Allow 30-60 seconds for notes, not a script.
- 2. Round 1.** Learner tells the story to Partner 1 for about two minutes. The partner listens and asks one genuine follow-up question.
- 3. Give one focused push.** Ask the learner to add a reason, use a more precise verb, clarify the sequence, include sensory detail, or use a target structure such as past perfect.
- 4. Round 2.** The learner tells the same story to Partner 2, incorporating the push. The partner listens for the added feature and asks a different follow-up.
- 5. Round 3.** The learner retells to Partner 3 with a new purpose, such as persuading the listener, emphasizing emotion, or reducing hesitation under a shorter time limit.
- 6. Reflect.** Learners identify one feature that became easier and one point that still required searching or reformulation.

INSTRUCTOR PROMPTS

- Add the reason this happened.
- Make the sequence clearer for your listener.
- Use a more precise verb or connector.
- Say that again with less hesitation.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

- Speech becomes more continuous without simply becoming faster.
- Later versions contain more detail or more complex connections.
- Learners retrieve useful phrases more automatically.

VARIATIONS

- Use a 4/3/2 timing sequence or retell from the listener's perspective.
- Record the first and final round for a short self-comparison.

WATCH OUT

Give repetition a new communicative purpose. Avoid piling on several targets at once, and distinguish improved fluency from speech that is merely faster.

ACTIVITY 05

Classroom Decision Challenge

Core push. *Learners formulate, extend, defend, and revise ideas because the group must reach a real decision.*

Purpose. Push extended reasoning, justification, response to peers, and reformulation in a socially meaningful speaking task.	Best for. B1-C1; groups of 3-5
Materials. A decision problem, option or evidence cards, role cards if needed, and a decision sheet	Timing. 25-35 minutes

WHY THIS IS PUSHED OUTPUT

Learners must produce language for a consequence that matters to the group: they need to state a position, support it, respond to another view, and revise wording when challenged.

PROCEDURE

- 1. Present the decision.** Give a problem with several defensible options, such as choosing language-club rules, redesigning a school schedule, or selecting a community project.
- 2. Prepare privately.** Ask each learner to choose a position and note two reasons plus one example or piece of evidence. This prevents the fastest speaker from doing all the thinking.
- 3. Initial positions.** Each learner states a position in one uninterrupted turn. Require listeners to note one idea they agree or disagree with.
- 4. Instructor follow-up.** Ask for specificity and consequences: Why? What evidence? How would that work? What would happen if the group chose the alternative?
- 5. Challenge and repair.** Learners respond to one peer, then restate or reformulate one point so it is clearer, better supported, or more precise.
- 6. Reach and report a decision.** The group agrees on an option and gives a concise rationale. End with an exit reflection on one phrase or structure learners had to search for.

INSTRUCTOR PROMPTS

- Can you make that claim more specific?
- Explain how that would work in practice.
- Respond directly to the previous speaker.
- Try that again with a clearer reason.
- What is your strongest evidence?

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

- Learners produce longer turns with causal and contrastive language.
- They take up, challenge, or build on a peer's idea.
- Reformulations improve the clarity of claims and reasons.

VARIATIONS

- Assign roles, evidence cards, a rotating chair, or a time limit.
- Run a second decision after brief feedback on interactional language.

WATCH OUT

Prevent one fluent learner from dominating. Assign turn roles and assess the quality of reasoning and language process, not only the group's final answer.

Printable materials for all five activities

The following pages make each activity stand-alone. Print the indicated learner materials, cut cards where marked, and keep hidden images face down until the reveal.

PACKET MAP

Activity	Core task	Included materials
Activity 1	Picture Story	Picture sequence, language bank, retell checklist, and push cards
Activity 2	Information-Gap Troubleshooting	Role A and Role B cards, repair prompts, and answer key
Activity 3	Describe and Draw	Two hidden images, listener drawing sheets, and comparison prompts
Activity 4	Three-Round Personal Story	Story prompt cards, push cards, and reflection sheet
Activity 5	Classroom Decision Challenge	Scenario, option cards, role cards, evidence cards, and decision sheet

GENERAL TEACHER SETUP

- Use the five activity pages as the teacher guide; use the following pages as ready-to-print learner materials.
- For pair tasks, print one Role A and one Role B page per pair. For card tasks, print one set per group and cut along the visible cell borders.
- The instructor's push should request more precise, longer, clearer, or differently organized output; it should not replace the learner's search with an immediate answer.

ACTIVITY 1 MATERIALS

Picture sequence and language bank

Learner copy. Keep the picture sequence visible during planning and the first narration.



OPTIONAL LANGUAGE BANK

First, the student notices something unusual.

Next, the student picks it up and looks around.

After that, the student asks someone for help.

Finally, the owner comes back and gets the backpack.

The student is worried because ...

The passerby suggests that ...

Teacher choice: allow learners to use the language bank during planning, then ask them to add at least one detail that is not shown in the sentence starters.

ACTIVITY 1 MATERIALS

Retell push cards and listener checklist

Cut the six push cards or display them one at a time. The listener checklist keeps the second narration meaning-focused.

CUT-APART PUSH CARDS

ADD A REASON Explain why the student acted.	MAKE THE SEQUENCE CLEAR Use first, then, after that, and finally.
USE A PRECISE VERB Replace a general verb such as got or went.	ADD ONE DETAIL Describe the place, object, or emotion.
CONNECT TWO EVENTS Use because, so, while, or although.	SAY IT AGAIN BETTER Keep the meaning, but make the message clearer.

LISTENER CHECKLIST

- [] I understood the main events.
- [] I heard a clear sequence of events.
- [] The speaker added a specific detail.
- [] The speaker repaired or improved one point.
- [] I asked one genuine follow-up question.

Follow-up question. What happened after that? / Why did the student do that? / What did the passerby notice?

ACTIVITY 2 MATERIALS

Role A card: bus timetable

Cut or hand this page to Learner A. Learner A must not show the card to Learner B.

Your group needs to travel from Campus to the Riverside Language Center on Saturday morning. Tell your partner only the information on this card. Ask questions when you need information from the other card.

SATURDAY BUS TIMETABLE

Route	Leaves Campus	Stop 1	Riverside stop	Later stop
Route 1	9:05	Main Library 9:15	9:35	Airport 9:55
Route 2	9:20	City Hall 9:30	10:10	Museum 9:50
Route 3	8:50	North Market 9:00	9:20	Stadium 9:40

YOUR JOB

- Read the departure and arrival information aloud when your partner asks.
- Do not show this card. Your partner has the travel rules and must tell you what the group needs.
- Ask at least one clarification question, such as Which route arrives later? or Does Route 2 stop at Riverside?

Useful language. Route 1 leaves at ... / It arrives at ... / Does it stop at ...? / Could you repeat the time?

ACTIVITY 2 MATERIALS

Role B card and teacher answer key

Cut or hand this page to Learner B. Learner B must not show the card to Learner A.

TRAVEL RULES

- The group must leave Campus after 9:00.
- The group must arrive at Riverside between 9:25 and 9:45.
- The bus must stop at Riverside; no transfer is allowed.
- The group wants to arrive as close as possible to 9:35.

YOUR JOB

- Ask Learner A for the timetable information you need.
- Do not show this card. Explain the rules in your own words.
- If your partner gives an unclear time or route, ask for clarification and repeat the corrected information.

TEACHER ANSWER KEY

Route 1 is the only solution. It leaves after 9:00, arrives at Riverside at 9:35, meets the 9:25-9:45 window, and arrives exactly as close as possible to 9:35.

Repair challenge. Ask each learner to restate one key rule or timetable fact in a different way before the pair checks the answer.

ACTIVITY 3 MATERIALS

Speaker image A

Teacher copy. Give the image only to the Speaker. The Listener should not see it until the reveal.



SPEAKER TARGET LIST

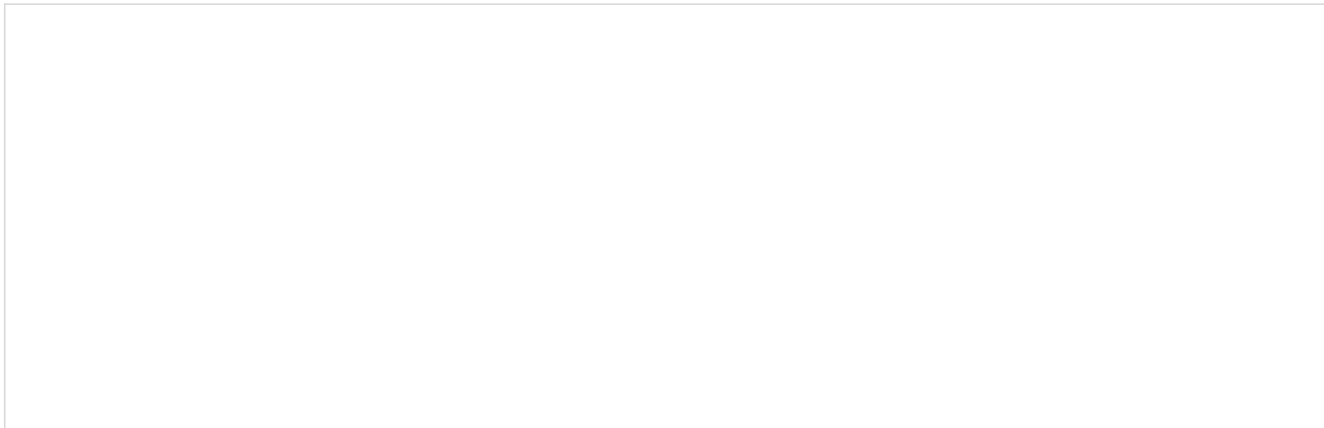
- Describe at least five objects.
- Use two location phrases, such as to the left of, behind, under, or near.
- Use one size, shape, or color comparison.
- Repair one description if the Listener seems unsure.

ACTIVITY 3 MATERIALS

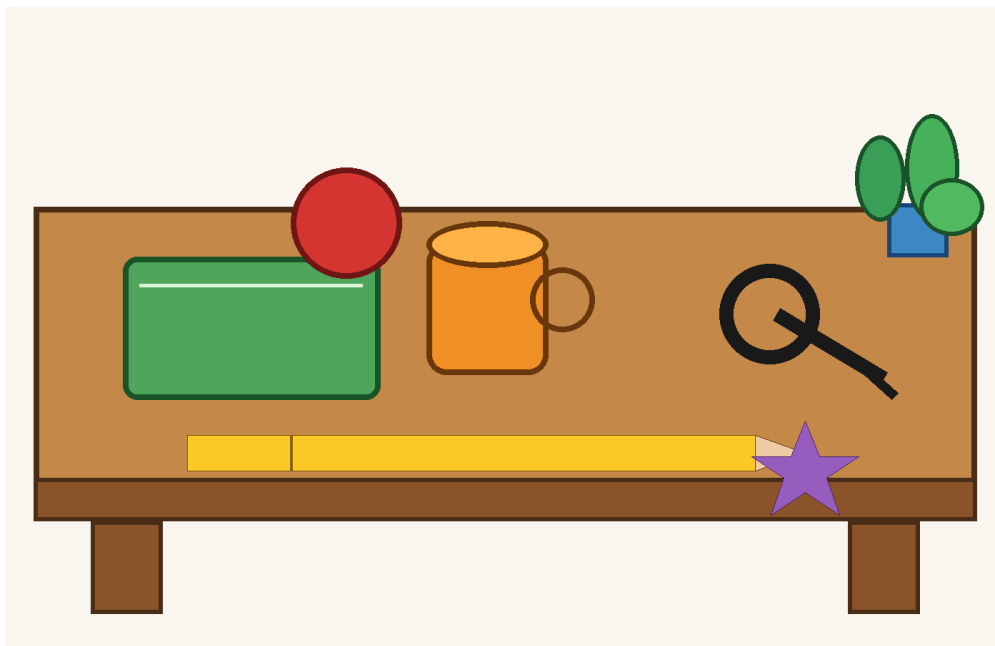
Listener drawing sheet and image B

Use Image B for the second round after learners reveal Image A and switch roles.

LISTENER DRAWING SHEET



The Listener may ask questions but should not look at the original image. Draw the objects and their relationships as accurately as possible.



Teacher: keep Image B covered until the second reveal. The exact arrangement is deliberately simple enough for learners to describe with prepositions and comparisons.

ACTIVITY 4 MATERIALS

Personal story prompt cards

Cut apart the cards. Each learner chooses one prompt and tells the same story three times with a new push each round.

A time you solved a problem	A memorable trip or outing
A meal that surprised you	A time something went wrong
A person who helped you	A difficult decision
A funny misunderstanding	A place you would return to
A skill you learned	A time you changed your mind
A small success	A day that did not go as planned

PARTNER FOLLOW-UP CARDS

What happened next?	Why was that important?
How did you feel?	What would you do differently?

ACTIVITY 4 MATERIALS

Push cards and learner reflection

Use one push card after Round 1 and a different one after Round 2. Avoid giving more than one main target at a time.

CUT-APART PUSH CARDS

ADD A REASON Explain why the event happened.	CLARIFY THE SEQUENCE Use before, while, after, or by the time.
USE A PRECISE VERB Replace a general verb with a more exact one.	ADD SENSORY DETAIL Include a sound, smell, texture, or visual detail.
PERSUADE YOUR LISTENER Make the story's lesson or point clear.	REDUCE HESITATION Retell it more smoothly without reading a script.

REFLECTION

- [] The part that became easier was ...
- [] The word or structure I had to search for was ...
- [] In Round 3, I changed ...
- [] One useful phrase I want to remember is ...

ACTIVITY 5 MATERIALS

Classroom decision scenario

Use one scenario per group. Learners must reach a decision and justify it with evidence.

SCENARIO: DESIGN A LANGUAGE LOUNGE

Your university has money to create one new language lounge for students. The lounge should encourage students to speak languages outside class, welcome different proficiency levels, and be practical to operate. Your group must choose one design and explain why it is the best use of the budget.

DESIGN OPTIONS

OPTION A: Conversation Café A drop-in space with themed conversation tables and volunteer hosts.	OPTION B: Media Studio A small recording space for podcasts, interviews, and speaking practice.
OPTION C: Game and Story Room A flexible room with board games, storytelling materials, and role-play stations.	OPTION D: Tandem Exchange Hub A scheduled matching program that pairs learners with speakers of other languages.

DECISION REQUIREMENTS

- Choose one option, not a combination.
- Give at least two reasons and one piece of evidence.
- Respond to at least one concern raised by another group member.
- State one limitation or risk of your chosen option.

ACTIVITY 5 MATERIALS

Role cards and evidence cards

Assign one role to each learner. The role should shape the learner's questions, not force a predetermined final answer.

ROLE CARDS

STUDENT REPRESENTATIVE Prioritize participation, welcoming atmosphere, and regular student use.	BUDGET PLANNER Ask about cost, staffing, space, and whether the plan can operate every week.
ACCESSIBILITY ADVOCATE Prioritize physical access, psychological safety, and opportunities for different proficiency levels.	COMMUNITY PARTNER Ask whether the lounge builds useful connections beyond the classroom.

EVIDENCE CARDS

A student survey found that many learners want low-pressure speaking practice.	The available room is small, so large drop-in events are difficult.
A media studio requires training and equipment maintenance.	Peer hosts are available, but only for limited weekly hours.
Students report that scheduled appointments are easy to forget.	Recorded speaking tasks can give learners a visible record of progress.

ACTIVITY 5 MATERIALS

Decision sheet and speaking checklist

One learner records the group's reasoning. The teacher can use the checklist during the discussion or as a quick exit assessment.

GROUP DECISION SHEET

Our choice. _____

Reason 1. _____

Reason 2. _____

Evidence. _____

Concern we answered. _____

Limitation or risk. _____

SPEAKING CHECKLIST

- [] I stated a clear position.
- [] I explained a reason with because, so, or therefore.
- [] I responded directly to another speaker.
- [] I asked for or gave evidence.
- [] I reformulated one point to make it clearer.
- [] I helped the group reach a decision.

Exit reflection. One phrase or structure I had to search for was ...